



Understanding college and employment preparation of transition-age youth with intellectual disability and autism using NLTS 2012 data

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Session objectives

- Explain the extent to which youth with ID/A are accessing college and employment preparation according to findings from recent data
- State three implications for improving transition practice based on findings



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Moving Transition Forward: Exploration of College-based and Conventional Transition Practices for Students with Intellectual Disability and Autism (ID/A) project will examine the composition and impact of existing transition practices via secondary analysis of two national datasets. This three-phase study will define, explore, and compare critical aspects of two transition approaches:

1. a college-based transition experience provided via partnership between a local education agencies (LEAs) and institutions of higher education (IHEs), and
2. a conventional transition experience offered by a LEA in a high school or community setting.



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Team Members



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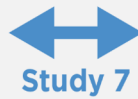


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MTF Studies

MOVING TRANSITION FORWARD STUDIES

**Conventional Transition
Services (NLTS 2012)**



**College-Based Transition
Services (TPSID)**

- Study 1 | Research-Based Predictors
- Study 2 | Employment Preparation
- Study 3 | College Preparation

- Research-Based Predictors | Study 4 ←
- Employment Preparation | Study 5 ←
- College Preparation | Study 6 ←



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Study Methods and Results



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Research questions

- To what extent are youth with ID/A are accessing college and employment preparation?
- Does the extent youth with ID/A are accessing college and employment preparation differ to youth in other groups (autism no ID, other disabilities, 504 plans, neither 504 plan nor IEP)?



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NLTS 2012

- Nationally representative sample of about 13,000 youth ages 13-21 during 2011-12 school year
- Phase 1: Surveys completed with parents and students

Phase 2 (in progress): high school and post-high school administrative records data to collect information in three broad areas important to understanding outcomes for youth with disabilities: (1) High school course-taking and completion (2) post-secondary education and training, and (3) employment and earnings after high school.



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Our sample

- Included youth who were age 16 or older

Group	N
Youth with ID (includes youth with autism and ID)	1,240
Youth with autism (no ID)	680
Youth with other disabilities who have IEPs	6,230
Youth with 504 plans	490
Youth with no 504 plan or IEP	1,360



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College and career preparation variables in NLTS 2012

College preparation activities

- Supplemental tutoring/instruction
- Help signing up for college entrance tests
- Help with financial aid
- College credit for high school classes
- Help completing college applications
- Took a college placement test
- Help reviewing results of college placement tests
- College visits/fairs

Both

- Staff from community service agency attended transition planning meeting
- Received guidance about which courses to take
- Received help identifying possible career options
- Took classes to prepare for a career
- Earned college credit for career classes
- Transition planning meeting occurred

Career preparation activities

- Had a written plan for classes to take
- Received guidance on classes to take to prepare for plans after school
- Worked for pay in the last 12 months



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Other important factors

Youth factors	Family factors	School factors
• Age • Gender • Race • Ethnicity • Communication skills • Independent/daily living skills • Self-determination skills	• Parent expectations for future independence • Household income • Parent education level • Parent employment • Parent involvement	• Locale • School academic proficiency • School's share of youth with IEPs • General vs. only for students with disabilities



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Analysis

- Data analyzed using SPSS Complex Samples
- Weights applied to generate national estimates
- Calculated:
 - Weighted estimate
 - 95% confidence interval
 - Chi-square test of statistical significance
 - Cohen's effect size h of differences



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Effect size – Cohen's h

- Measure of the magnitude of differences across groups
- $ES < .20$ negligible
- $ES \geq .20$ small
- $ES \geq .50$ medium
- $ES \geq .80$ large



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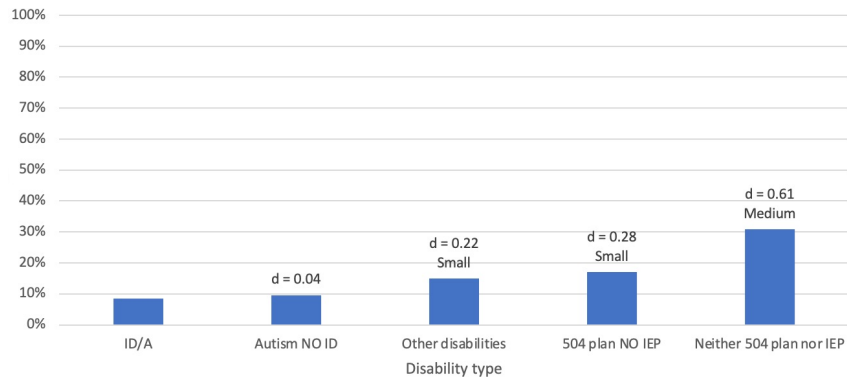
College Preparation Activities



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Youth took part in a program or service that provides help with financial aid forms, comparing financial aid packages

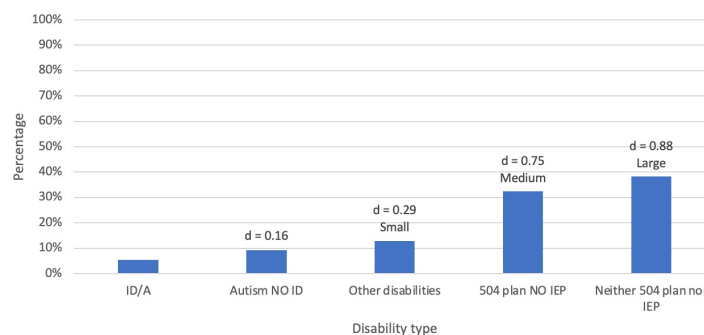
	ID/A	Autism NO ID	Other disabilities	504 plan NO IEP	Neither 504 plan nor IEP
Yes	8%	9%	15%	17%	31%



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Youth took courses at their high school for which they earned college credit

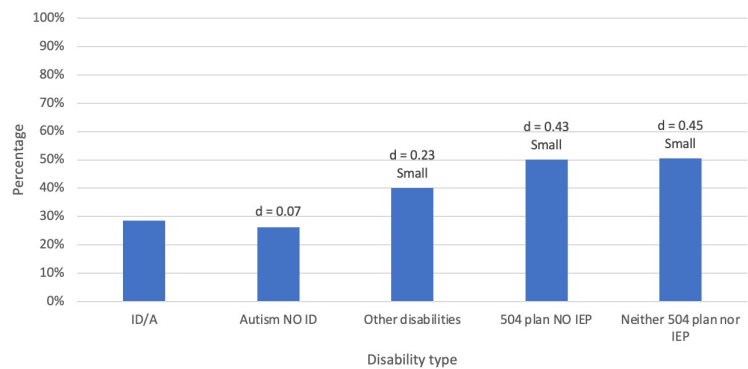
	ID/A	Autism NO ID	Other disabilities	504 plan NO IEP	Neither 504 plan nor IEP
Yes	5%	9%	13%	32%	38%



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School staff provided youth with help completing college applications

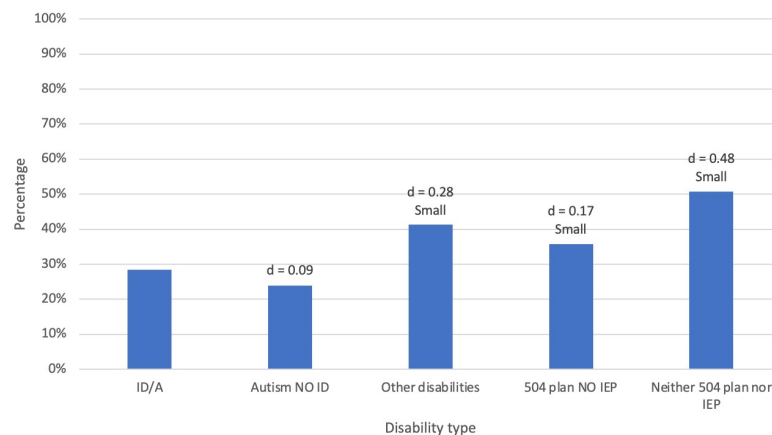
	ID/A	Autism NO ID	Other disabilities	504 plan NO IEP	Neither 504 plan nor IEP
Yes	29%	26%	40%	50%	51%



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School staff provided help arranging or taking youth on visits to colleges or college fairs

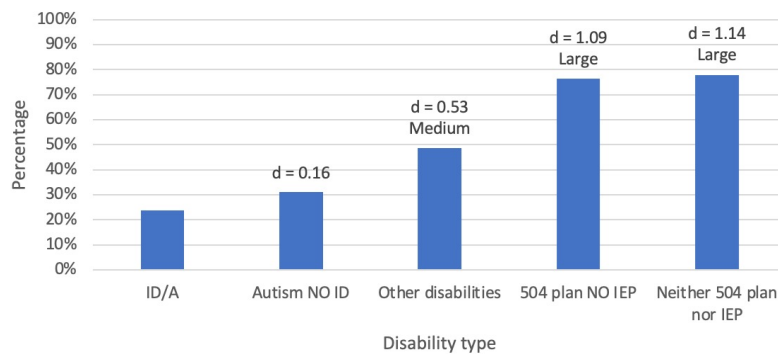
	ID/A	Autism NO ID	Other disabilities	504 plan NO IEP	Neither 504 plan nor IEP
Yes	29%	26%	40%	50%	51%



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Youth took a college placement test (PSAT, SAT, ACT, or placement test for a local college)

Disability type	ID/A	Autism NO ID	Other disabilities	504 plan NO IEP	Neither 504 plan nor IEP
Percentage	24%	31%	49%	76%	78%



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Transition Implications

- Transition Educators need to
 - Support students with ID to access college classes while enrolled in high school
 - Be aware of federal student aid options for students with ID/A
 - College and university options
 - Provide support for more students to complete FSA and college applications



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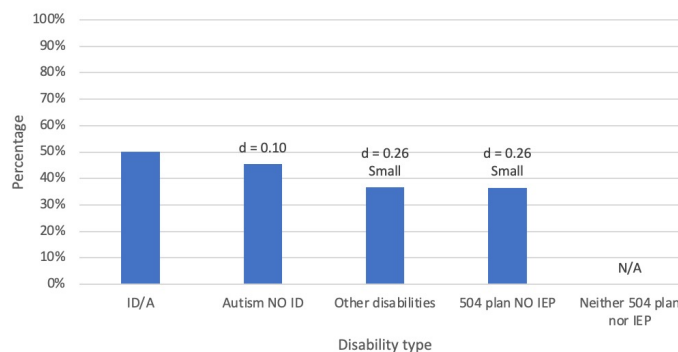
College and Career Preparation Activities



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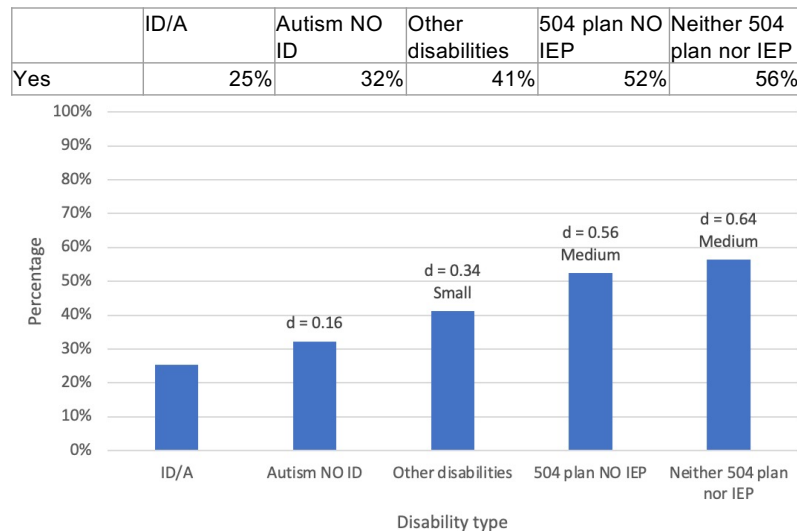
Staff from a community service agency (e.g., VR) attended the transition planning meeting

	ID/A	Autism NO ID	Other disabilities	504 plan NO IEP	Neither 504 plan nor IEP
Yes	50%	45%	37%	37%	na



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Youth took courses in high school designed to expose or prepare them for a career (or careers) of interest



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Transition Implications

- Community service agency involvement is important but has a tricky relationship with post-school outcomes
- Look around the transition planning table...Who has higher education and employment expertise?
- Career coursework in high school may still be difficult for students with ID/A to access



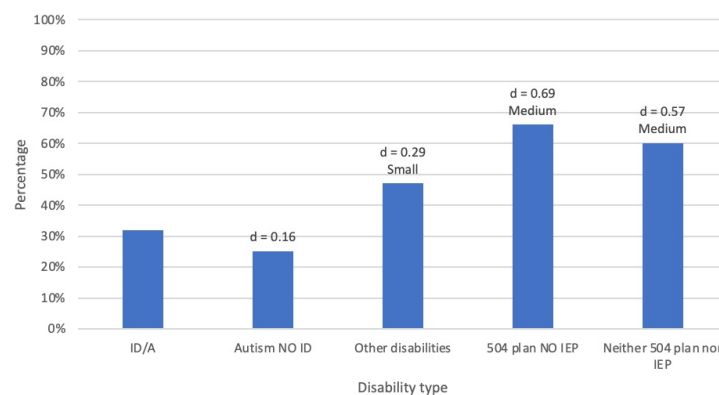
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Youth worked for pay in the past 12 months (not including school-sponsored jobs or work around the house)

	ID/A	Autism NO ID	Other disabilities	504 plan NO IEP	Neither 504 plan nor IEP
Yes	32%	25%	47%	66%	60%



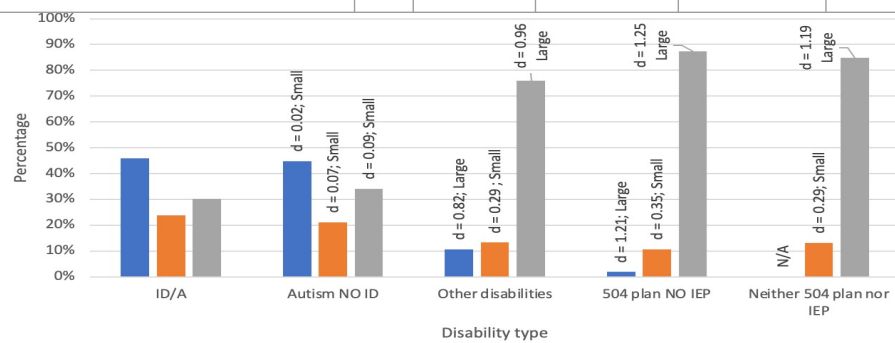
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Parent expects youth will be living on their own and/or financial self-supporting at age 30

	ID/A	Autism NO ID	Other disabilities	504 plan NO IEP	Neither 504 plan nor IEP
No expectations for either living or finance independence	46%	45%	11%	2%	na
Expectations for either living or finance independence	24%	21%	13%	11%	13%
Expectations for both living & finance independence	30%	34%	76%	87%	85%



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Implications for Transition Practice



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College and Career Preparation activities are not mutually exclusive

- Six activities support both outcomes-difficult to tease out which are most impactful without outcome data
- Providing student with ID access to employment during high school IS a part of college preparation
- Other variables are very low bars in terms of preparation (e.g., existence of a transition plan)



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Big Picture Implications

- More college preparation than career preparation variables in this dataset
- No information about the quality of services
- Little information about level of inclusion
- Does not reflect any college-based transition services



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Recommendations

- Discuss both college and employment goals for all students regardless of their disability label
- Build opportunities for paid employment during high school
- Learn about college options for students with ID/A and share this information with families and students



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